

INFORMATION BOOKLET

Positive Partnerships and Autism CRC Meeting

Monday 10 – Wednesday 12 August 2026

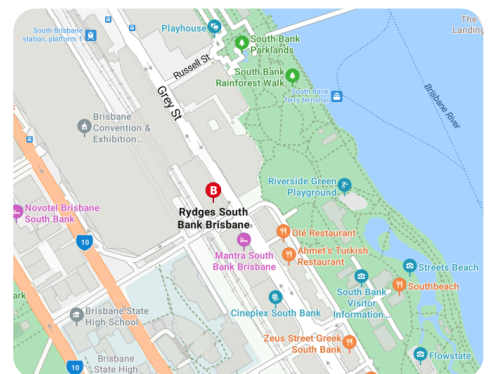
Rydges South Bank, Brisbane



Rydges South Bank Brisbane

9 Glenelg Street, South Bank, Brisbane

Travelling by taxi? Just show the driver this address.



Map link:

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Welcome

Positive Partnerships would like to acknowledge the Turrbal and Yuggera peoples of the lands where this meeting will take place. We pay respect to elders past and present.

We're excited to welcome you to our gathering, collaborating with the Autism CRC as we consolidate the new content for Phase 5. It's a truly special opportunity to have our First Nations Reference Group, Multicultural Collaboration Group, Autistic Advisory Group, Autism CRC and Positive Partnerships staff all together in one space – to learn, share, and enjoy each other's company.



All of us together at our 2025 face-to-face gathering.

South Bank and the surrounding areas of Brisbane are located on the traditional lands of the Turrbal and Yuggera (Jagera) peoples, who have lived along the Brisbane River for thousands of years. Known traditionally as Meeanjin, meaning "*place of the blue water lilies*," Brisbane was an important gathering place where Aboriginal communities met for trade, cultural activities, ceremonies, and the sharing of knowledge.

Today, South Bank remains an important place for recognising and celebrating First Nations culture. Within walking distance of Rydges South Bank are several significant cultural sites including:

- **kuril dhagun, State Library of Queensland** (slq.qld.gov.au/visit/spaces/kuril-dhagun) — A dedicated First Nations cultural and community space featuring exhibitions, storytelling, digital displays, and community gathering areas. The space is named after the *kuril* (water rat), an animal of cultural significance to the area.
- **Aboriginal Art Co.** (aboriginalart.co) — A First Nations-led, not-for-profit gallery and cultural enterprise dedicated to ethical and authentic Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander art. It provides opportunities to connect with artists, attend cultural programs, and purchase authentic artworks.

Our meeting will take place at the Rydges Hotel in South Bank, Brisbane, a stunning location close to the banks of the Brisbane River. You'll be just a short walk or ferry ride from some of the city's most beautiful and iconic spots – South Bank Parklands and lagoon, across the Neville Bonner Bridge into the city the Botanic Gardens or a ferry ride to Howard Smith Wharves.

You can find out more about Rydges South Bank at rydges.com/accommodation/brisbane-qld/brisbane-south-bank.

Autism CRC team

We will meet and work with members of the Autism CRC on Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday. Raymond, the therapy dog will also be in the working space with us; off lead. Please let your Positive Partnerships contact person know if you have any concerns about this or reach out to Emma Dresens on the days.



Liv Gatfield
(she/her)



Nicole Torres
(she/her)



Brendan James
(he/him)



Cheryl Mangan
(she/her)



Hayley Clapham
(she/her)



Kiah Latham
(she/they)



Raymond
(good boy)

Information about Raymond

- Raymond is Autism CRC's certified therapy dog. Liv Gatfield is his handler.
- He will be at the workshop each day, and staying at the hotel.
- He is certified to work off lead, so won't be on a lead in the function room. If you have concerns about this, please contact Emma Dresens on edresens@positivepartnerships.com.au or 0401 106 096.
- Therapy dogs are there for everyone, so you can pat and play with him.

Meeting guidelines

We begin on Monday with those in attendance coming together to learn more about the art of facilitation with Kerry Bissaker. This day was optional, so not all group members will be attending on Monday.

About Kerry

Dr Kerry Bissaker is an adjunct Associate Professor at Flinders University following 28 years of research and teaching in education with a specific focus on designing and evaluating professional learning for educators in the fields of autism and inclusive education. She has successfully supervised several doctoral candidates researching autism and the lived experiences of autistic adolescents.

Tuesday and Wednesday will look, sound and feel a lot different to our last collaboration, and we'll experience a different way of working as we collaborate with the Autism CRC.

We will be following different timelines for each program and we will be using multiple ways of working to share and record reflections and considerations on each concept.

The purpose of the meeting is to share the updated parent/carer and professional learning content overview and contribute to the development of activities for each of the workshop models. There will be time for the First Nations Reference Group and Multicultural Collaboration Group to focus on the programs they support.

For some of the activities we will be seated in mixed groups from the First Nations Reference Group, Autistic Advisory Group, Multicultural Collaboration Group and Positive Partnerships team. At other times you will be working with your specific group.

Meeting objectives

- Confirm suitable activities for PL and PC session delivery, with activities differentiated, where relevant, for:
 - primary, secondary, school leaders, support staff and early career teachers
 - online and face-to-face delivery
- For the First Nations Reference Group to yarn about the content, activities and videos for the Yarning and Sharing about Autism workshop and make recommendations.

Communication preferences

At the workshop you can wear a coloured dot to show others how you'd like to communicate:

- **Green** – Open to engage in conversation with others
- **Amber** – Open to engage but would prefer others to start the conversation
- **Red** – Prefer to listen but may engage when I'm comfortable

Remember, if your communication preferences change during the workshop, you can change your dot colour.

Agenda

Monday 10 August

9:00am	Acknowledgment of Country
9:05 – 9:15am	Housekeeping and introductions
9:15 – 10:45am	Kerry Bissaker Facilitation Skills
10:45 – 11:15am	Morning Tea
11:15am – 12:30pm	Kerry Bissaker Facilitation Skills continued
12:30 – 1:15pm	Lunch
1:15 – 2:30pm	Kerry Bissaker Facilitation Skills continued
2:30 – 2:45pm	Afternoon Tea — Movement/brain break
2:45 – 3:45pm	Kerry Bissaker Facilitation Skills continued
3:45 – 4:00pm	Wrap up and finish

Tuesday 11 August

9:00 – 9:50am	Welcome to Country – Uncle Steven Introductions and welcome
9:50 – 10:00am	Connection activity
10:00 – 10:45am	Autism CRC Collaboration introduction: overview of the project; co-design process; expectations; shared purpose for the 2 days; brief walk through of current content
10:45 – 11:00am	Movement break/brain break activity brainstorm
11:00 – 11:30am	Morning Tea
11:30am – 1:00pm	Parent Carer content: learning activity, led by PP staff at tables
1:00 – 1:45pm	Lunch
1:45 – 3:00pm	Professional Learning content • Autistic Advisory Group • First Nations Reference Group • Multicultural Collaboration Group
3:00 – 3:15pm	Afternoon Tea — Brain break/movement break
3:15 – 4:00pm	Professional Learning content continued • Autistic Advisory Group • First Nations Reference Group • Multicultural Collaboration Group
4:00pm	Conclude the day

Wednesday 12 August

Prior to 9:00am	Check out
9:00 – 9:15am	Acknowledgement of Country Recap of previous day
9:15 – 10:30am	Professional Learning content continued • Autistic Advisory Group • First Nations Reference Group • Multicultural Collaboration Group
10:30 – 11:00am	Morning Tea
11:00am – 12:30pm	Professional Learning content continued • Autistic Advisory Group • First Nations Reference Group • Multicultural Collaboration Group
12:30 – 1:15pm	Lunch
1:15 – 2:30pm	<i>Showcase/sharing of what has been created</i>
2:30 – 3:00pm	Wrap up and conclude
3:00pm onwards	Taxi to airport for those flying Travel home

Travelling to and from the event

Taxi to and from the airport

If you are travelling via plane, you will receive digital CabCharge passes via SMS that you can upload to your phone wallet. You will receive enough passes to get you from your home to the airport, to the event and back home again. Your key contact in Positive Partnerships will contact you to make sure everything runs smoothly. You may be asked to travel with a Positive Partnerships colleague who is arriving at a time similar to yours. Your key contact will speak to you in advance about this.

Train to and from the airport

Another option, if you prefer, is to take the train. Trains run direct from the airport to South Brisbane Station and cost \$23.30 (less if booked online in advance), paid via credit card. Follow signs in the airport to the platform and board the AirTrain heading to the Gold Coast – you will not have to change trains.

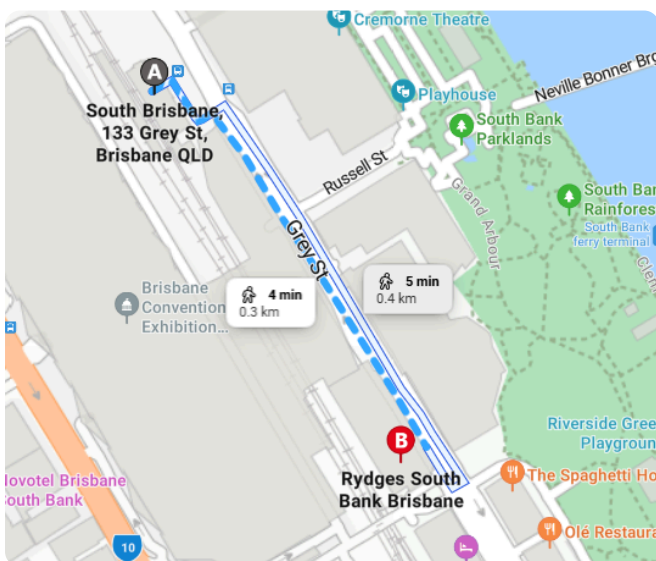
The closest train station is **South Brisbane Station**. Upon exiting the station, you will see the Queensland Performing Arts Complex. Turn right onto Grey Street. Walk approximately 300 metres along Grey Street; the hotel is on the same side as the station. It's about a 4-minute walk from South Brisbane Station to the hotel.

Driving and parking information

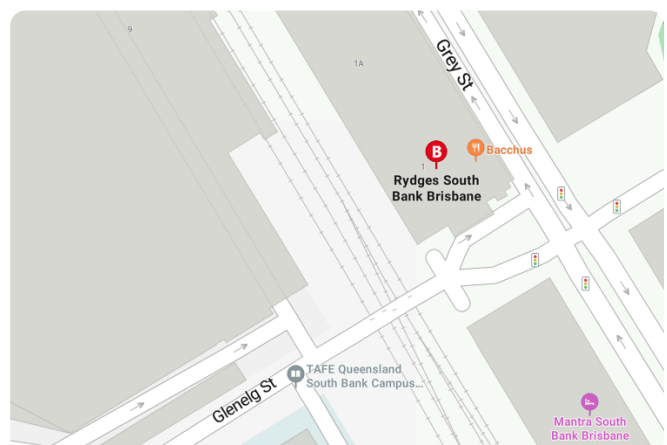
If you live in Southeast Queensland and are driving to the event, Positive Partnerships will cover the cost of your parking.

Rydges have valet service parking – if you are driving to the hotel, park in the main driveway and advise the concierge of your name and that you are attending the **Phase 5 Content Workshop**. They will do the rest!

Where to enter: on the corner of Glenelg and Grey Streets, enter off Glenelg Street.



Walking route from South Brisbane Station to the hotel.



Driveway entry for valet parking, off Glenelg Street.

Travel changes or questions

If your travel plans change or you have any questions about the event, please get in touch with your contact person:

First Nations Reference Group and Multicultural Collaboration Group

- Emma Dresens – Manager, Diverse Community Programs
- edresens@positivepartnerships.com.au
- 0401 106 096

Autistic Advisory Group

- Vanessa Alexander – Manager, Programs
- valexander@positivepartnerships.com.au
- 0403 815 841

Optional extras to bring

- Activewear for walking or using the hotel gym
- Swimmers for the pool or South Bank lagoon
- Umbrella or raincoat for any wet weather
- Note-taking materials if you'd like to make notes across the event
- Fidgets or sensory tools — there will also be some available in the room

Dietary considerations

Just a reminder that if you haven't already given your dietary preferences to your Positive Partnerships contact, please do so. This will make sure we have suitable options available for you at the event.

Meals provided

- **Breakfast** – included in your room rate each day. Please give staff your room number when you are seated. As breakfast is provided, it cannot be claimed as an allowance from Positive Partnerships.
- **Monday** – morning tea, lunch and afternoon tea
- **Tuesday** – morning tea, lunch and afternoon tea
- **Wednesday** – morning tea and lunch
- **Dinner on Monday and Tuesday** – free time and your own choice, or join an optional team dinner. Claim meal allowance costs as usual.

Places to eat

There are many places to eat close to the hotel, mainly along Grey Street, Little Stanley Street and in South Bank Parklands. Some suggestions are:

CBD Café — in Rydges hotel; coffee, snacks and quick meals
Open 7:00am – 10:00pm
(07) 3364 0800

Ma Pa Me — Southeast Asian cuisine
Shop 6C Little Stanley Street, South Bank
Open 11:30am – 3:00pm and 4:00 – 9:00pm
(07) 3130 0445 — mapame.com.au/menu

Riverside Café and Bar
South Bank Parklands, Shop 31BD
Open 7:15am – 7:00pm
(07) 3846 7380 — riversidecafeandbar.com

Zeus Street Greek
13/14 Little Stanley St
Open 11:00am – 9:00pm
0407 778 752 — zeusstreetgreek.com.au

Chu The Phat — Asian fusion
111 Melbourne St, South Brisbane
Open noon – 3:00pm and 5:00 – 9:00pm
(07) 3255 2075 — chuthephat.com.au

Hotel Terminus — pub menu
73 Melbourne Street, South Brisbane
Open 11:00am – 10:00pm
(07) 3131 8951

Take-away options include Nando's, Guzman y Gomez, Grill'd and McDonald's — all located on Grey Street; turn right as you head out of the CBD entrance.

Great coffee

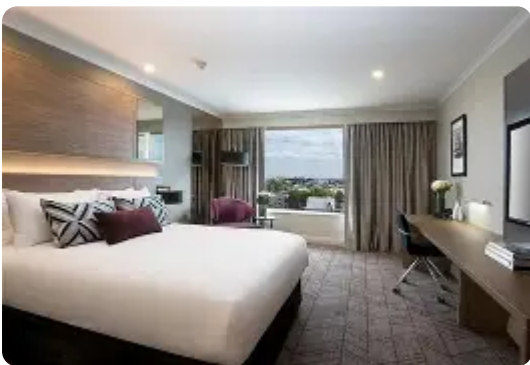
- **Coffee at the Kombi** — on the Brisbane River, open at 5:30am
- **Coffee Ish** — 51 Fish Lane, South Brisbane, open at 6:30am

Arriving at the hotel

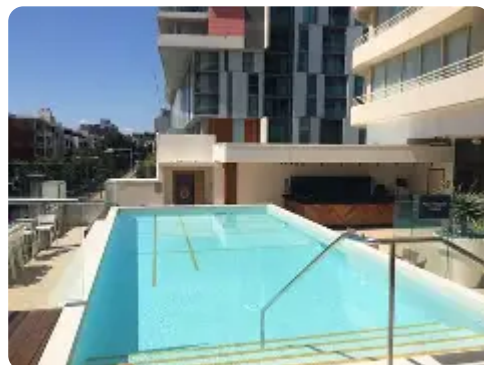
Rydges South Bank Brisbane — 9 Glenelg Street, South Bank, Brisbane



This is the entrance to the hotel. The lobby area where you check in is just through these doors.



This is one of the rooms.



The pool is located on Level P (Podium) and open 6:00am – 6:00pm.



The gym is located on Level 1. Open 6:00am – 10:00pm.



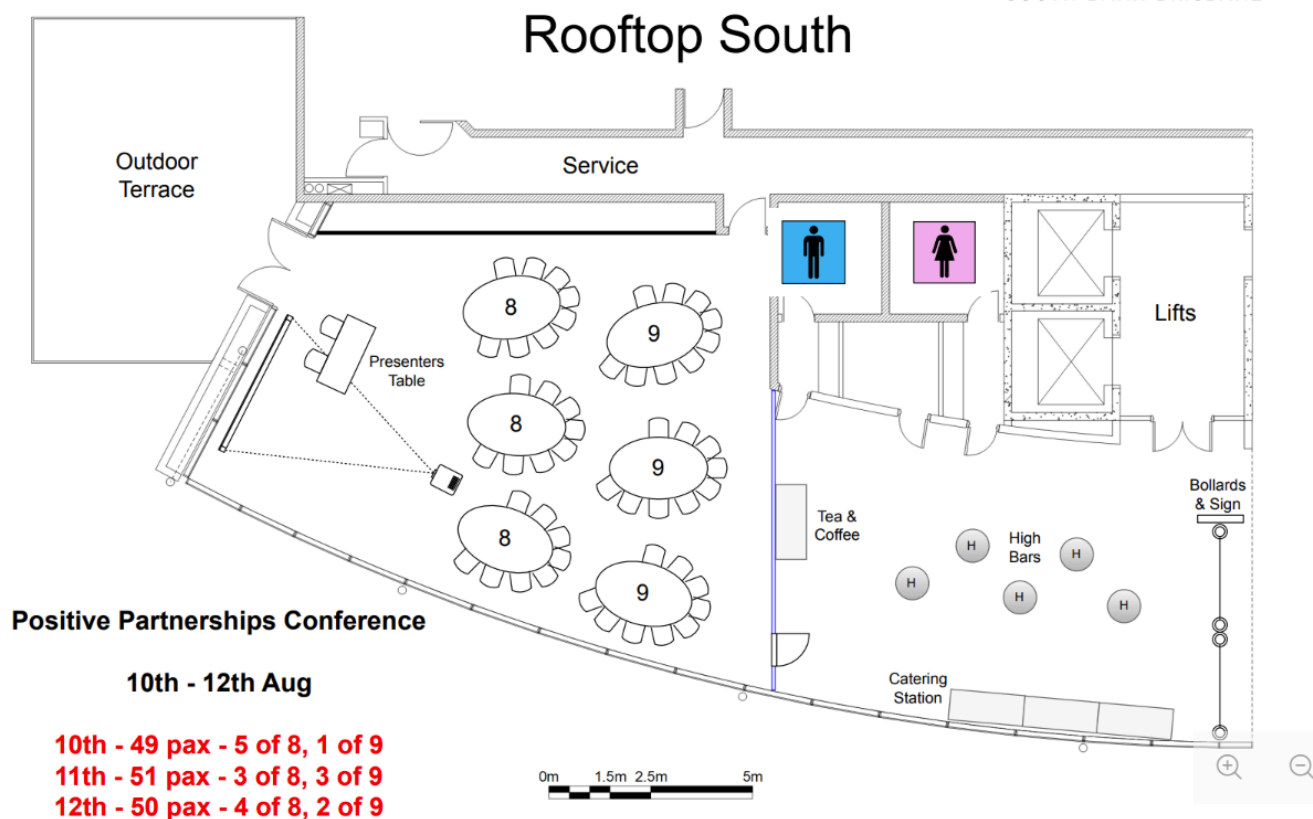
On the ground floor next to the lobby there is CBD Café and Bar, open 7:00am – 10:00pm.

Our meeting room

We will be meeting on the 12th floor in Rooftop South. There will be breakout and quiet spaces available.

RYDGES

SOUTH BANK BRISBANE



Floor plan of Rooftop South, Level 12 — our meeting space for the three days.